

Work & Careers

69 words · Work & Careers

NOUNS

job

a paid position of regular employment
She's been looking for a job since finishing university.

salary

a fixed regular payment for employment, usually monthly
His salary doubled when he moved to the private sector.

colleague

a person you work with
She gets on well with all her colleagues.

employer

a person or organisation that employs people
Your employer is legally required to provide a safe working environment.

contract

a formal agreement between employer and employee
Always read your contract carefully before signing.

deadline

the latest time by which something must be completed
The deadline is Friday. There's no time to waste.

shift

a set period of time worked, especially with rotating hours
She works the night shift three times a week.

redundancy

the state of being made unemployed because the job is no longer needed
He was offered voluntary redundancy after the restructure.

work

activity involving mental or physical effort done to earn money
How's work going? Busy, but I'm enjoying it.

boss

a person's manager or employer
My boss asked me to stay late to finish the report.

employee

a person who works for someone else in exchange for payment
The company has over two hundred employees.

career

the series of jobs a person has over their working life
She's built an impressive career in finance over twenty years.

interview

a formal meeting to assess a candidate for a job
He was nervous before the interview but it went well.

promotion

advancement to a higher position or rank
She was offered a promotion after just two years.

workload

the amount of work a person is expected to do
Her workload has increased significantly since the merger.

appraisal

a formal assessment of an employee's performance
Her annual appraisal highlighted strengths and areas for improvement.

incentive

something that motivates someone to work harder

A performance bonus is a powerful incentive for staff.

sabbatical

a period of paid leave for professional development or research

She took a six-month sabbatical to write her book.

deep work

a period of focused, distraction-free effort on a cognitively demanding task

She blocks out two hours of deep work every morning before checking email.

vacancy

a job or position that is available and needs to be filled

There are two vacancies in the marketing department.

hustle culture

the glorification of constant work and side projects as a lifestyle

She rejected hustle culture and prioritised rest and balance instead.

ADJECTIVES

employed

having a paid job

She's been fully employed since graduating three years ago.

full-time

working or involving the standard number of hours per week

She's looking for a full-time position in marketing.

rewarding

providing personal satisfaction or a sense of accomplishment

She finds working with children deeply rewarding.

motivated

having a strong desire to do or achieve something

She's highly motivated and rarely needs to be chased for work.

indispensable

absolutely necessary; too valuable to do without

A good PA can make themselves indispensable within weeks.

conscientious

taking great care to do work thoroughly and correctly

She is conscientious, always double-checking her reports.

unemployed

without a paid job; out of work

He's been unemployed for six months and is actively looking.

part-time

working fewer hours than the standard working week

He works part-time while studying for his degree.

self-employed

working for oneself rather than for an employer

As a freelancer, he has been self-employed for five years.

demanding

requiring a lot of skill, time, or effort

Teaching can be one of the most demanding jobs there is.

lucrative

producing a great deal of profit or financial gain

Investment banking is notoriously lucrative but stressful.

VERBS

apply

to formally request to be considered for a job

I applied for three jobs this week.

hire

to employ someone for a job

They're hiring ten new staff for the summer.

fire

to dismiss someone from their job

He was fired for repeatedly missing deadlines.

retire

to stop working permanently, usually at a certain age

He plans to retire at sixty-five.

delegate

to assign a task to someone else, usually a subordinate

Good managers know when to delegate.

resign

to formally and voluntarily leave a job or position

She decided to resign after a disagreement with the board.

headhunt

to approach someone employed elsewhere and offer them a job

He was headhunted by a tech company offering twice his salary.

quit

to leave a job, often without much notice

She quit her job and went travelling for a year.

commute

to travel regularly between home and work

She commutes two hours each way by train.

collaborate

to work jointly with others on a project or task

The two departments collaborated closely on the product launch.

outsource

to hire an external company to do work rather than doing it in-house

Many firms outsource their customer service to reduce costs.

micromanage

to control every small detail of a team's work

Staff morale suffered because the director tended to micromanage.

PHRASAL VERBS

take on

to accept new work or employ new staff

The company decided to take on twenty new apprentices.

follow up

to contact someone again about something already discussed, or to check on its progress

I'll follow up with the supplier if we haven't heard anything by Wednesday.

lay off

to dismiss employees because of lack of work

The factory laid off two hundred workers due to falling demand.

slack off

to start working less hard or to become lazy

People tend to slack off on Fridays, especially in the summer.

hand in

to formally submit something, such as a resignation

She handed in her notice after ten years at the firm.

burn out

to become exhausted through sustained overwork

He burned out after working eighteen-hour days for two years.

circle back

to return to a topic, task, or person at a later point

Let's circle back to the budget once we've heard from finance.

knock off

to stop working, especially at the end of the day (informal)

What time do you knock off? Usually around six.

COLLOCATIONS

work from home

to do your job from your house rather than going to an office

She works from home two days a week.

flexible hours

a work arrangement that lets employees choose when they start and finish, within limits

The company offers flexible hours, so I usually start at seven and finish early.

meet a deadline

to complete work by the required date

She always meets her deadlines, even under pressure.

work your way up

to advance from a low position through effort

He worked his way up from intern to managing director.

climb the career ladder

to progress to higher positions in one's career

He worked hard to climb the career ladder in a competitive industry.

IDIOMS

get the sack

to be dismissed from a job (informal)

He got the sack after arriving late for the third time.

pull your weight

to do your fair share of the work in a team or group

If everyone pulled their weight, the project would be finished by now.

snowed under

overwhelmed with a large amount of work

I can't take on anything new right now, I'm completely snowed under.

a safe pair of hands

a reliable person who can be trusted to handle things well

They appointed her because she was seen as a safe pair of hands.

have a lot on your plate

to be dealing with many tasks or responsibilities at once

I'd love to help with the presentation, but I've got a lot on my plate this month.

hit the ground running

to begin a new job with great energy and preparation

The new recruit hit the ground running from day one.

carry the can

to take the blame for something, often unfairly

When the project failed, it was the junior staff who carried the can.

in the pipeline

being planned or developed but not yet complete

A new performance review system is in the pipeline.

SET PHRASES

touch base

to make brief contact with someone to check in or exchange updates

Let's touch base on Monday morning before the client call.

MODERN SLANG

quiet quitting

doing only the minimum required without formally leaving

Half the team seemed to be quiet quitting after the restructure.

side hustle

a small job or business you run alongside your main employment to earn extra money

She designs wedding invitations as a side hustle at weekends.

grind culture

the glorification of overworking as a badge of honour

She's pushed back hard against grind culture since burning out.